

Game Concept Overview:

Palchemy is a follow-up to my earlier game jam demo, Super Pal Summoners. It's a 2D, board-based puzzle game where players strategically place tiles to summon pals and earn points.

Each level presents a unique board and a specific objective, such as summoning certain pals or reaching a target score. Players carefully plan their moves to optimize tile placements, aiming to complete the objective before the board fills up.

Focusing on thoughtful spatial positioning and chain reactions, Palchemy challenges players to think ahead and discover solutions through clever tile combinations.

Target Audience:

With flexibility in mind, Palchemy's gradual non-time-based structure makes it perfect for players with busy lifestyles. Whether during a commute or between tasks, players can jump in and out without losing progress or momentum.

Palchemy features simple tap-to-place controls and easy-to-learn mechanics, making it highly accessible and engaging for casual players and those new to gaming.

Finally with bright visuals, adorable pals, and playful tone, Palchemy creates an atmosphere that appeals to a wide age range. Its friendly aesthetic makes it an ideal entry point for younger gamers and a relaxing experience for older ones alike.



(Gameplay image from original)

Platform and Technical Requirements:

Palchemy is being developed specifically with mobile platforms in mind, targeting both iOS and Android devices for launch. While its predecessor, Super Pal Summoners, was built for web and intended for play on both PC and mobile, feedback from over 200 players revealed a strong desire for a fully optimized, native mobile experience.

In response, Palchemy will deliver a mobile-first user experience, featuring intuitive touch controls, responsive UI design, and support for various screen sizes covering both smartphones and tablets. By focusing on native development for iOS and Android, Palchemy aims to provide smooth performance, quick loading times, and integration with platform-specific features such as cloud saves, notifications, and achievements.

Development Timeline Estimate

Palchemy is planned to be developed over the course of one year by a dedicated team of four full-time members: one game designer, one programmer, one visual artist, and one music / sound effects lead.

Additional support will be brought in during key phases, particularly for playtesting, to gather feedback, validate design choices, and refine mechanics based on user experience.

Core Gameplay Mechanics

Merging:

Each tile type, such as a duck tile, has a specific configuration that must be met to summon a pal. For example, placing three duck tiles in a row triggers a merge that summons a Duck Pal. When a merge occurs, all tiles involved in the required configuration are removed from the board, along with any additional adjacent tiles of the same type. So, if four duck tiles are aligned, all four will be consumed during the merge, not just the minimum three.

Successfully summoning a pal through merging grants the player points. Bonus points are awarded when the number of tiles used in the merge exceeds the required minimum, rewarding players for creating larger merges.

Tile Placing:

The player has only one available tile to place on the board at any time. This is done by dragging or tapping on an empty board position. With each tile placed, a position on the board is filled, with the exception of when a merge occurs due to the new tile placement.

Upcoming Tiles:

Tiles are pseudo-randomly generated and put into a queue, from which the player must place them in the order they appear. While the underlying randomization system may use methods like bag generation, where a larger pool of tiles is pre-generated to ensure fairness and reduce excessive tile repeats, the player will only be able to see a limited preview of the upcoming tiles in the queue.

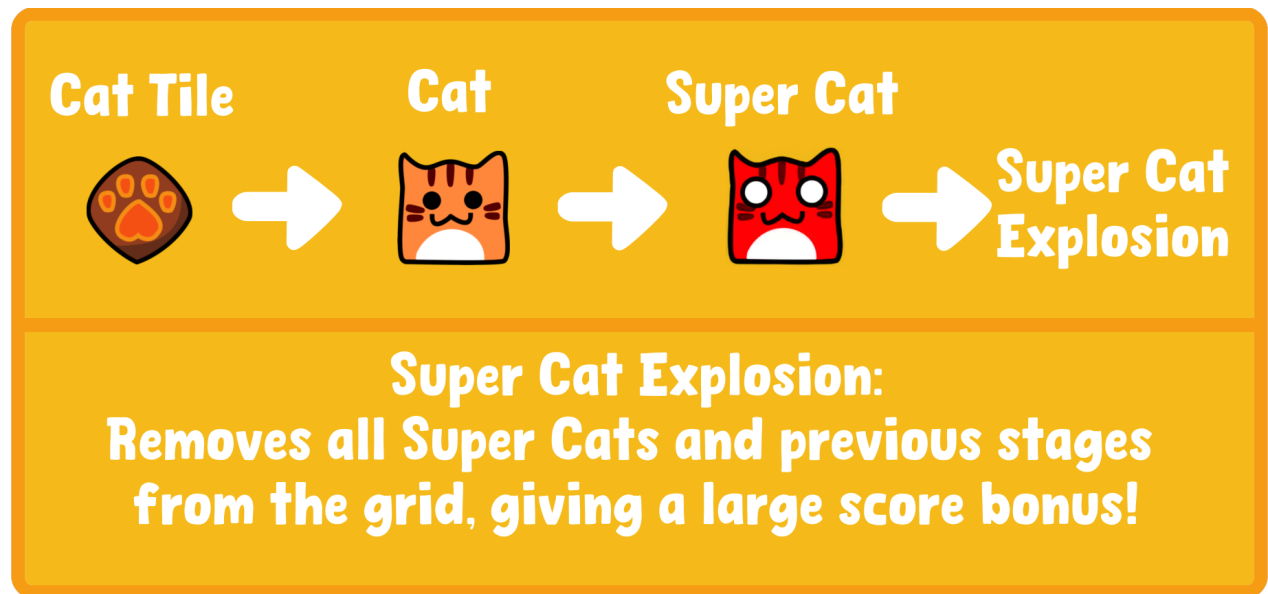
This approach strikes a balance between unpredictability and strategy, allowing players to plan a few moves ahead without fully revealing the entire sequence, thus maintaining tension.

Tile Progression:

Each standard tile follows a three-stage merge progression, encouraging players to build toward increasingly powerful outcomes. The first stage involves summoning a basic pal, for example, merging duck tiles summons a Duck Pal. In the second stage, merging multiple Duck Pals creates a Super Duck (a more advanced version with a distinct visual design.) Finally, merging multiple Super Ducks triggers the super ability for that pal type, unleashing a powerful effect that can dramatically impact the board.

Camera Shifting:

To support larger boards without sacrificing visual clarity, Palchemy introduces a camera shifting system. Players can toggle between play mode and view mode using an in-level UI button. In view mode, the player can drag the camera freely across the board, allowing them to explore areas beyond what typically fits well on a single screen. This feature enables the design of expansive, more complex boards while maintaining high-quality visuals and a clean interface during gameplay.



(Info-slide of merge stages)

Genre and Style

Palchemy is a 2D, board-based puzzle game with elements of tile-matching, combo-building, and light strategy. Designed with a focus on accessible gameplay and satisfying mechanics, it blends the planning and spatial reasoning of classic puzzle titles with a charming aesthetic.

Unique Selling Points

Palchemy stands out through its blend of strategic depth, variety in level design and casual accessibility. Its core mechanic, summoning pals through clever tile placement and merging, offers a satisfying twist on familiar puzzle gameplay. The game's mobile-first design, combined with intuitive touch controls and short, self-contained levels, makes it ideal for both quick sessions and extended play. With its adorable creature designs, a gradually expanding roster of pals, and a light fantasy aesthetic, Palchemy invites players of all ages to explore, experiment, and relax, while still offering rewarding challenges for those who seek mastery.

Player Experience Goals

Building on extensive player feedback from Super Pal Summoners, Palchemy is designed to be a deeper, more intuitive experience for mobile players:

Clearer Combo Logic & Onboarding:

Many players were initially confused about how tile merges worked, especially which patterns summoned which pals, where the resulting pal appeared, and how extra tiles were cleared.

To solve this Palchemy will introduce a tutorial during the first playthrough. A mini combo guide will also always be visible during play. Finally, clearer in-game feedback through animation such as showing how tiles will merge together should help players to “get it” quickly and feel confident from the start.

Undo Functionality:

Accidental misclicks were a recurring frustration, often breaking carefully laid strategies. A simple “undo last move” feature allows players to recover from mistakes without removing challenge, encouraging thoughtful play without punishing experimentation.

Rewarding Strategic Play:

Some players felt they could progress just by clicking randomly. The new scoring system will reward players who minimise the number of merges more strongly with larger scores given for chain reactions and even potentially include some levels with specific merge amount requirements.

Snappier, More Responsive Input:

Several players noted that dragging felt slow or imprecise with animations sometimes slowing down the pace.

Palchemy will improve drag speed, and make it clear to players that tapping tiles into the is also an option (as some did not realise). Finally there will be settings to increase the speed of animations in the game to give the player more freedom.

Improved Placement Preview:

Misplacements were mentioned to occur due to unclear tile feedback.

A visual “ghost” preview will now show exactly where and what tile will be placed, reducing errors and improving usability.

More Satisfying Visual Effects:

Players loved the style but wanted bigger payoffs for combos and merges. Merges now trigger fun animations, subtle screen shake, and themed particle effects that give each moment impact without cluttering the screen. Additionally with higher tile progression merges these effects will be amplified.

Richer Audio & Background Music:

Many requested background music and more reactive sound design. Palchemy will include a soft, adaptive soundtrack to support its cozy tone, with new SFX layers tied to pal actions, combos, and board clears, making the game feel more alive.

Mobile-First User Experience:

Feedback showed strong demand for a version that felt native to phones, rather than adapted from the web. Palchemy will feature layouts planned for mobile, and optimization for both smartphones and tablets across iOS and Android.

Perfect for Busy Players:

The original game's short, relaxing style was a notable love with players looking for low-commitment games. Palchemy embraces this with quick levels, no time pressure, and the ability to pause and resume effortlessly.

Progressive Unlocks and Pals:

Players loved discovering new pals and strategies but still felt a need for more length. To fix this Palchemy will add a bigger variety of unlockable pals, new mechanics revolving around the board itself, unique level layouts and goals.

Multiple Game Modes:

Many players reached high scores but wanted more than just endlessly increasing their score. New modes like daily puzzles, level-based objectives, and challenge boards with other players will allow for ongoing content beyond just endless play.

Core Game Loop

Palchemy has a simple yet deeply strategic core loop: place tiles => trigger merges => summon pals => earn points => repeat. Each turn, the player receives a new tile from a queue and must decide



(Cobbleclam Tile concept:
Merge three in a row diagonally
to summon a Cobbleclam)

its placement on the board. Tiles can be merged, summoning pals and clearing space on the board. As players continue placing tiles, they work toward building larger merges, triggering multi-stage evolutions (e.g. Super Pals), and activating powerful effects.

The player is constantly evaluating trade-offs: Should they clear space now or hold out for a bigger combo? Should they risk blocking a future merge to complete a current one?

Player actions and controls

The primary player action is placing tiles onto a board. Players can achieve this by tapping any open board space to place the current tile or dragging the tile to a desired space and releasing it to place it. Both methods have their own pros; while tapping tiles into the board is much quicker, dragging gives the advantage of seeing a highlight preview of where the tile will be placed and gives a “ghostly preview” that shows what merges will occur if placed.

Secondary actions the player can do include:

- Toggling “view mode” to shift the camera across the board
- View upcoming tiles in a queue to plan ahead.
- Open the combo guide to check pal merge patterns.
- Undo their last move to recover from mistakes.
- Navigate between and select levels and chapters.
- Access a settings menu for toggling sound, visual effects, or accessibility options.

Game systems and interactions

Scoring System:

Players earn points with every successful merge, and the score scales based on the complexity and effectiveness of each move. Merges that use more tiles than the minimum required grant additional points, encouraging players to aim for larger, more efficient setups. Creating chain reactions, where one merge triggers another, also boosts the score. As players progress from merging basic tiles to summoning pals then to Super Pals and finally activating the unique Super Pal ability, each stage gives increasingly higher point values.

Energy System:

To help structure session pacing and promote healthy play habits, Palchemy features a light energy system. Each level attempt consumes a small amount of energy, which naturally recharges over time.

Progression and rewards

Palchemy delivers a steady sense of progression and discovery, rewarding players not just for high scores but for continued play and growing mastery. Building on the foundation of Super Pal Summoners, new tiles and pals are introduced gradually to maintain surprise and engagement. While levels retain the endless, score-based system, Palchemy expands progression across themed level sets, each with unique tile pools and board layouts. Early levels focus on core mechanics, with later stages introducing new tiles, pals, and board spaces that feature passive or interactive effects, adding variety and challenge.

Levels are structured into a campaign format, culminating in an unlockable Heroic Mode, which remixes earlier stages with tougher objectives and advanced tiles introduced sooner, offering deeper replayability and strategic depth.



(Cobbleclam Pal concept: Will convert into Clagma if placed on top of a heat source or next to any fire type pal. Merging Cobbleclams summons Super Cobbleclam.)

Engine choice and justification

Given Palchemy's design as a 2D, mobile-first puzzle game with a strong focus on responsiveness, iteration speed, and platform flexibility, Godot 4.4 is currently the preferred engine. It offers faster iteration, easier integration of touch-based controls, and clean export workflows to mobile platforms, all without sacrificing performance or artistic control. Should the project's scope shift toward heavier visual effects or a need for 3D elements, Unreal will remain a viable alternative.

Technical requirements and architecture

The game's technical architecture emphasizes lightweight performance, modular systems, and a responsive user interface to ensure smooth gameplay across a wide range of devices.

At its core, Palchemy is structured around a data-driven tile and merge system, enabling flexible definition of new tile types, merge rules, and pal behaviors without requiring extensive hardcoding. This modular design supports rapid iteration, content expansion,

and future updates, such as new pals, seasonal events, or challenge modes, without disrupting core functionality.

The game will run at 60 FPS on modern smartphones, with a focus on minimizing input latency, optimizing animation timing, and reducing memory size. Asset management (sprites, SFX, UI elements) is optimized for mobile through texture compressed formats, while the underlying logic is designed to remain performant even as the board complexity scales.

For development, we are planning to implement a MVC-inspired architecture. The model handles tile board state, merge logic, and score tracking. The view manages rendering, animations, and transitions. Finally, the controller interprets player input and coordinates querying the model and passing information to the viewing system.

(Selection of floor concepts)



(Bluestone)

(Stone)

(Lava: A heat source
that limits what tiles
and pals can be
placed on it)

Performance targets and optimization considerations

To maintain broad device compatibility, the game is engineered to run efficiently on both modern smartphones and older mid-range devices. This includes careful attention to memory usage, battery impact, and storage footprint.

A key goal for Palchemy is to keep the total install size under 150MB, well below App Store / Google Play limits and ideal for quick downloads and updates.

When considering memory usage and battery impact, the game should offer adjustable visual settings (e.g., effects toggle, animation speed, and particle intensity) to allow

players on lower-end devices to maintain performance without impacting core gameplay.

Additionally, frequently used tiles, effects, and particle systems should be tested using object pooling to examine if it can reduce memory allocation spikes, allowing for smoother gameplay.

Finally the UI and visual elements should be built with resolution independence in mind, allowing dynamic scaling on devices with different screen sizes without degrading quality or performance.

Platform considerations and deployment strategy

Our primary target platforms are Android and iOS. While Palchemy plans to focus on using a single cross-platform code base allowing for reuse of code modules, specific platform dependent modules will be made to take advantage of unique ecosystem features such as cloud saves (iCloud/Google Play Games) and achievements (Game Center/Google Play Games Services). To help with not only deployment but also development we will frequently bring in external play testers with both Android and IOS devices to ensure platform dependent bugs can be spotted and resolved continuously.

Visual style and art direction

Palchemy embraces a bright, playful, and character-driven visual style that reinforces the game's accessible, cozy tone. The art direction draws inspiration from casual mobile puzzle games and light fantasy aesthetics, using bold colors, soft shapes, and expressive characters to make every element on screen instantly readable and visually inviting.



The game features a 2D vector art style, with clean lines and high-contrast silhouettes that support gameplay clarity. Tiles are designed to be easily distinguishable at a glance, with strong iconography and distinct color palettes for each tile type. This visual clarity ensures players can quickly assess the board state and plan their moves without confusion or visual noise and allows the game to be accessible to a wider range of people with vision capabilities.

Each pal has a unique, charming personality expressed through idle animations, summoning effects. As players progress and unlock Super Pals or advanced tile types,

(Clagma Pal concept:
Will convert into Cobbleclam if
moved off of a heat source or
away from neighbouring fire
type pals. Merging Clagmas
summons Super Clagma.)

the visuals evolve in a way that feels rewarding, with bolder visuals that put on a bigger spectacle without undermining the theming.

The UI is designed with a friendly, mobile-optimized layout, using rounded buttons, soft drop shadows, and smooth transitions to create a cohesive feel. Visual feedback plays a central role in the moment-to-moment experience: merges trigger animated bursts, particle effects, with pals even planning to give reactions when merges occur nearby.

The overall goal of Palchemy's art direction is to create a light, mystical atmosphere that feels welcoming to players of all ages while supporting gameplay clarity and long-term visual appeal. The art style strikes a balance between charm and clarity, ensuring that even when the board is densely packed late in a level, the visuals remain readable and the experience stays calm, not chaotic.

Audio design and music style

Palchemy's audio design will reinforce its cozy world, providing satisfying feedback and a relaxing atmosphere. The music style will feature a soft, adaptive soundtrack that supports the game's inviting and lighthearted tone. This background music will be calming and loopable, enhancing the sense of a low-pressure, engaging puzzle experience. Distinct music tracks may be introduced for advanced stages to subtly indicate progression without disrupting the overall tranquil mood.

Tile placements will be accompanied by a small, non-intrusive sound effect, with subtle randomization applied to its pitch and speed. This variation aims to prevent auditory fatigue, given the frequency of this action, maintaining a fresh and satisfying feel for every tile placed. Merges will trigger their own custom sound effects, with more advanced stage merges evolving into longer, more triumphant sounds, similar to the satisfying feedback found in Super Pal Summoners. This tiered audio feedback provides a clear sense of progression and reward.

To enhance the game's charming personality, sound effects will also play for pals reacting to changes on the board; for example, happy cheers will celebrate successful merges, while sadness sounds will occur when the game's lose state occurs as the board has no space left. Like the merge system, chain reactions will feature increasingly intense sound effects as they extend, providing a build-up that shows the growing excitement and impact of these more impactful plays. Finally, subtle sounds for menu navigation, button presses, and objective completion will provide essential feedback, ensuring players feel connected throughout their playthrough.

UI/UX design principles

Palchemy focuses on integrating all ten of Jakob Nielsen's Usability Heuristics to create a smooth, intuitive, and engaging user experience. While the game reflects strong design fundamentals across the board, it excels particularly in four key areas: Visibility of System Status, Error Prevention, Consistency and Standards, and Aesthetic and Minimalist Design.

Visibility of System Status covers the game's clarity. Palchemy gives players instant, satisfying feedback for every action, tile placement previews, merge animations, combo sounds, and real-time score updates ensure that the system always communicates what's happening.

Error Prevention is carefully considered for the possible player actions. Tile previews and animated merge hints help guide players toward optimal placements, reducing frustration. Additionally, visually showcasing upcoming tiles leaves less guess work on the players meaning that they are less likely to back themselves into a corner. Having an undo button helps out the player if they change their mind for where to place tiles or if an accidental tap occurred. Confirmation pop ups will also exist when players plan on making irreversible changes such as resetting the level back to the beginning.

Consistency and Standards has the game's interface follow established mobile UX patterns, including tap-to-place, drag-and-drop. Combo patterns also stay consistent for each tile and pal type regardless of how far through the game you are.

Finally, the game is guided by a principle of Aesthetic and Minimalist Design. The interface uses soft colors, clean layouts, and focused visual hierarchy to prioritize gameplay clarity. Even in complex levels near the end of the campaign, contrast and layering maintain visual readability without sacrificing charm.

Game World Structure and Level Progression

Palchemy is structured around a level-based world map, guiding players through handcrafted puzzles divided into themed chapters. Each chapter introduces new pals, tile mechanics, and visual styles, with early chapters



(Tutorial Grassy Meadows concept)

focused on onboarding and later ones adding complexity through unique tile behaviors, board modifiers, and strategic challenges.

Progress is tracked visually on the map, with some chapters and bonus levels unlocking non-linearly. Each level uses a three-star system: one star is enough to move forward, but unlocking new chapters requires a total star count, encouraging players to revisit earlier levels for higher performance.

This structure balances accessibility and mastery, supporting both casual progression and deeper replayability for those aiming to optimize their strategies and achieve full completion.

Environmental Storytelling

Each chapter or region introduces a new setting, such as Grassy Meadows, Ancient Ruins, or Arcane Towers, designed with a distinct color palette, background artwork, and ambient effects. These environments aren't just aesthetic, they reflect the types of pals and tiles introduced within that chapter.

For instance, a mountain top oriented chapter might focus on snow or air related pals, while a deep cavern may feature shadowy or crystal coated creatures. This consistent pairing of setting and game mechanics helps players intuitively understand the magical world they're exploring.

Development Phases and Milestones

Phase 1 – Pre-Production (Month 1)

- Establish the foundation of the project by finalizing core mechanics, gameplay systems, and visual direction. Create early prototypes to validate tile placement, merging, and board behavior.
- Milestone: Core game loop and base prototype complete.

Phase 2 – Core Development (Months 2–4)

- Build out the game's essential systems, including level structure, scoring, UI, animation, and audio. Begin playtesting and implement the star-based progression system.
- Milestone: Internal alpha build with 10+ playable levels and all core functionality in place.

Phase 3 – Content Expansion & Polishing (Months 5–8)

- Develop full chapters with unique visuals, new pals, tile types, and advanced mechanics. Implement localization, tutorial systems, and refine game feel through extensive playtesting.
- Milestone: Content-complete beta build with all main chapters and heroic mode.

Phase 4 – Platform Integration & Testing (Months 9–10)

- Optimize performance for iOS and Android, integrate platform-specific features (e.g. cloud saves, achievements), and conduct internal QA and closed beta testing.
- Milestone: Final release builds prepared and ready for submission.

Phase 5 – Launch & Post-Launch Support (Months 11–12+)

- Release the game globally and begin monitoring analytics and player feedback. Roll out post-launch updates, new content, and seasonal events to extend longevity and engagement.
- Milestone: Official release live with an active post-launch roadmap in place.



(Crystalpine Pal Concept: Three Crystalpines merge into a Super Crystalpine when placed in a straight line with gaps between them. Gaps can be one or multiple empty tiles.)

Resource requirements and Team Structure

Palchemy will be developed by a small four person with the following specialised roles:

Game Designer: Designs core mechanics, tile systems, level goals, chapter structuring, balancing, and progression.

Programmer: Implements board logic, tile interactions, merging systems, UI functionality, and platform-specific deployment (iOS/Android).

Visual Artist: Creates 2D assets including tiles, pals, animations, backgrounds, UI icons, and environmental effects.

Audio Designer: Produces all music tracks, sound effects, and audio feedback for gameplay events and UI.

Additional resources needed include: QA Testers, a suite of Android and iOS phones/tablets for compatibility and usability testing, marketing and publishing support, language localization consultants and access to Apple Developer and Google

Play accounts. The necessity of these resources will vary depending on the development period.

Risk Assessment and Mitigation Strategies

Developing Palchemy within a 12-month timeline presents key risks due to its small team size and mobile-first scope. Scope creep is managed through regular team check-ins and timeline tracking, ensuring features stay aligned with the original vision. Performance issues on lower-end devices are mitigated by optimizing throughout development, with a dedicated polish phase and role-specific expertise to ensure efficiency in art, code, and audio.

To address QA limitations, external testers will be brought in to help uncover bugs and edge cases across diverse devices. Finally, to reduce the risk of low market visibility, a specialized external marketing partner will support launch strategy and promotion.

Version control and project management strategy

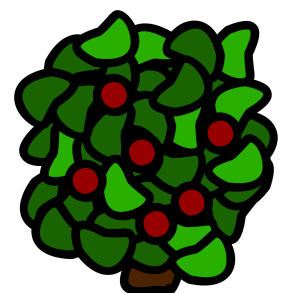
To support efficient, organized development, Palchemy uses a structured Git-based version control system hosted on GitHub. Each team member works in separate development branches to minimize conflicts and maintain traceability, with larger collaborative features handled in shared branches. Git LFS is used to manage large assets, and all commits are clearly documented and linked to issues for easy rollback and review.

Builds are milestone-tagged and regularly backed up both locally and to the cloud. Tasks are tracked through GitHub Issues, with time estimates and ownership assigned to prevent overlap and scope creep. Milestones are directly tied to the project's five development phases, ensuring clear alignment between planning, progress, and delivery.

Testing and Quality Assurance Approach

Throughout development, the team will bring in continuous external testing for core mechanics, objectives clarity, pacing, difficulty curves and overall UI/UX reviews to ensure accessibility, and intuitive navigation across all devices.

The external testing pool will be intentionally diverse in skill level, device type, and personal backgrounds to catch bugs and usability issues across a wide range of player profiles.



(Berry Bush concept:
Obstructs floor,
preventing tile or pal be
placed on it. Can be
destroyed by having fire
type pal or heat source
neighbouring it.)

Smaller internal testing sessions will take place more often to ensure that merging branches are stable and that new features are not straying too far from the vision laid out.

Competitive Analysis

Palchemy enters a highly active segment of the mobile games market, casual puzzle games with a focus on tile-merging mechanics, light strategy, and level based progression. To position the game effectively, I've looked at three notable competitors to identify trends, gaps, and opportunities that Palchemy is uniquely suited to fill.

Merge Mansion is one of the top-performing merge puzzle games on both iOS and Android, known for its polished presentation and strong narrative framing. However, its level structure often feels repetitive, with cut-and-paste board layouts and similar merging patterns reused across stages. While it benefits from ongoing content updates, the game leans heavily into long-term progression loops and monetization mechanics that prioritize retention over gameplay variety.

Merge Dragons! emphasizes collection, habitat-building, and fantasy-themed merge mechanics. It's visually rich and successful with a large player base, but similarly suffers from repetitive level design—many puzzles feel structurally identical, offering minimal variation between stages. The game is also built around idle systems and in-app purchases, creating a heavier time and financial commitment loop for sustained engagement.

2048 remains one of the most iconic early examples of spatial tile-merging. Its extreme minimalism made it highly accessible and instantly playable. However, that same simplicity leads to limited depth and little progression, with gameplay that remains largely the same over time, offering minimal incentive for long-term play or mastery.

From this analysis here is the two key takeaways Palchemy aims to use in order to distinguish itself from these similar games:

Aiming for Unique, High-Quality Levels: Each level features unique objectives, tile configurations, and evolving spatial challenges. Its multi-modal system, which alters both board layouts and tile pools, ensures each chapter introduces fresh mechanics and visual themes, enhancing replayability and player engagement.

Reducing Intrusive Monetization: Palchemy takes a player-friendly approach to monetization, focusing on sustainable engagement rather than aggressive revenue tactics. For example with the energy system, players will be presented with a prompt, encouraging them to take a break and return later feeling refreshed. For those who

wish to continue immediately, a single optional ad can be watched to unlock unlimited play for the rest of the day. This more respectful approach allows players to stay immersed on their terms while still supporting the game's longevity.

Altogether, Palchemy delivers a curated, strategic, and charming alternative to typical merge games, designed for those who value creativity, progression, and mastery over grind.

Target market research

Puzzle games remain one of the top-performing categories on mobile. However, many top-performing games suffer from predictable level design, over-monetization, or idle-heavy progression, leaving a gap in the market for a more polished, curated alternative.

Palchemy fills this gap by offering original merging gameplay, handcrafted levels, and light environmental storytelling, wrapped in a visually charming and respectful experience designed to retain players without overwhelming them.

Monetization Strategy

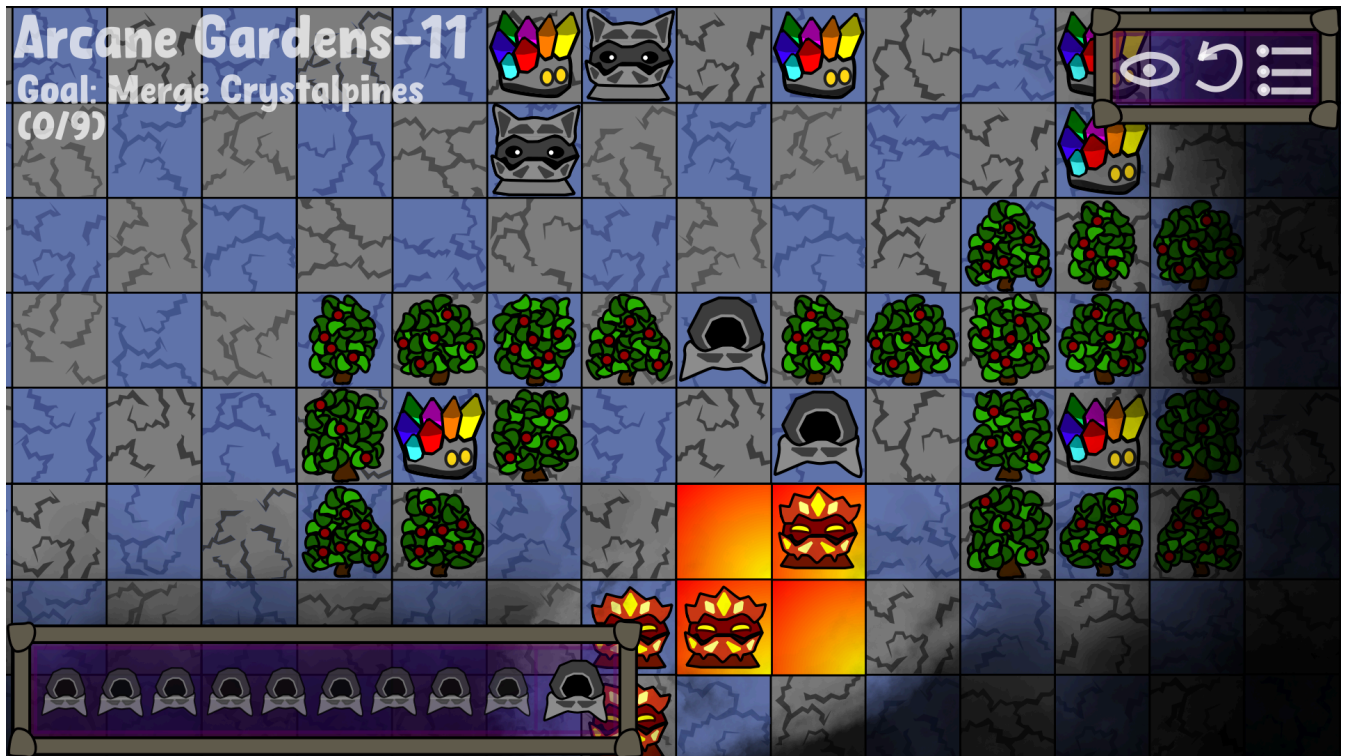
Palchemy adopts a player-first monetization strategy that emphasizes fairness, optional spending, and long-term engagement over aggressive tactics. The goal is to generate sustainable revenue while maintaining player trust and satisfaction and overall keep a loyal longlasting fanbase. This is a key differentiator in a genre often criticized for exploitative practices. The primary monetization model will be free-to-play with optional in-app purchases and ads, designed around two pillars:

Energy Bonuses: Palchemy offers a single, optional ad that grants unlimited play for the rest of the day. This gives a low-friction solution that respects the player's time while providing a subtle monetization opportunity.

For players who prefer to bypass energy limits entirely, Palchemy also offers a one-time purchase to permanently remove the energy system. Priced affordably at the lowest allowed in app purchase tier (\$0.99 USD on Google Play, \$0.29 USD on the App Store), this option caters to players who value uninterrupted gameplay without recurring spending or advertising.

Cosmetic In App Purchases: Monetization in Palchemy is focused on non-intrusive, purely cosmetic content that allows players to personalize their experience without affecting gameplay balance. Available purchases will include, alternate background themes for chapters or menus, unique tile and pal skin variations and customizable

player profile icons and frames for use on leaderboards or in social features. These cosmetic options are designed to add charm and personality while preserving the game's core fairness and accessibility. All purchases are optional, and the game remains fully playable and enjoyable without them.



(Full "Arcane Gardens" level concept: This level appears in a chapter beyond the first and serves as an introduction to the Cobbleclam tile, highlighting its unique duality, summoning either Cobbleclams or Clagmas based on placement. It also showcases Clagma's heat-based properties, such as the ability to be on top of lava and burn away bushes, enabling clear lines of sight for merging Crystalpines. The image above illustrates a possible portion of the viewable level.)